When Every Second Counts

Keep this page easy to find. If something feels life-threatening, don't read. Call.

Call 911 if your child:

- Is struggling to breathe or can't cry, cough or speak
- Has blue or gray lips, tongue or face
- Has a first-ever seizure, or one lasting 5 minutes or longer
- Won't wake up or is limp and unresponsive
- Has a severe injury or heavy bleeding
- Has swelling of the lips or tongue with trouble breathing

1-800-222-1222

Poison Control, 24/7, free and confidential. Call right away for any medicine, chemical, plant, battery or magnet your child may have swallowed, even if they seem fine. Don't make them vomit. Online help: poison.org.

Go to the emergency department now if your child:

- Is under 2 months old with a temperature of 100.4°F (38°C) or higher
- Is very hard to wake, floppy, or not acting like themselves
- Is breathing fast or working hard to breathe
- Has green vomit, or blood in vomit or stool
- Shows dehydration: few wet diapers, no tears, dry mouth
- Has a rash of tiny purple-red spots that don't fade when pressed
- Swallowed a button battery or magnets
- Had a head injury followed by vomiting or unusual sleepiness

Call your pediatrician today if:

- Your baby is 2 to 3 months old and has a fever (call right away, even at night)
- Fever lasts more than 3 days, or more than 24 hours under age 2
- Your baby is feeding much less than usual
- A symptom keeps getting worse instead of better
- Your child seems "off" and you can't say why
- You're worried. That's reason enough.

You don't need to be certain, and you don't need permission. If you're torn, get your child seen.